

Eli Marshall Davis, Ph.D. Candidate

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Academic Degrees

- **Ph.D. Candidate, Teaching and Learning**
University of South Carolina, Columbia, SC | Expected 2026
 - **M.S., Educational Leadership and Director of Curriculum**
Cardinal Stritch University, Milwaukee, WI | 2015
 - **B.S., Psychology**
University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee, WI | 2008
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Fellowships and Professional Development

- **Fellow, Race, Equity, and Leadership in Schools**
The Principals' Center, Harvard Graduate School of Education | 2019
 - **Fulbright-Hays Group Projects Abroad**
Nigeria (2022), Barbados (2023)
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Professional Experience**Adjunct Instructor, ED 319: Introduction to Exceptional Education**

Miles College, Fairfield, AL | August 2024 – Present

- Teach foundational concepts and culturally responsive strategies in special education
- Integrate the SAUCE framework to foster self-awareness, inclusion, and critical engagement
- Develop assignments and assessments aligning with IEP processes and equity pedagogy

Special Education Teacher, Autism Behavior Unit

Moody Elementary, Moody, AL | 2024 – Present

- Deliver specialized instruction and behavioral support for students with autism spectrum disorder
- Collaborate with multidisciplinary teams to create and implement IEPs

Interventionist, Leadership Team

Hemphill Elementary, Birmingham, AL | 2023 – 2024

- Chair of MTSS/PST committee; coached boys' basketball

Special Education Teacher

Various districts | 2008 – 2023

- Designed and implemented IEPs for diverse learners, K–12
- Leadership roles: MTSS chair, educator mentor
- Schools include: Jackson Creek Elementary (2022–2023), Inglenook K-8 (2021–2022), McAdory Middle (2020–2021), Lincoln Heights Academy (2016–2019), Durham Public Schools (2015–2016), St. A Transition Therapeutic School (2008–2012)

Graduate Internship – Assistant Principal

North Division High School, Milwaukee Public Schools, WI | 2014 – 2015

Owner/Operator

Hriam LLC, Milwaukee, WI | 1998 – 2014

- Founded and managed community-based residential facilities for adults with disabilities
- Led 12-person staff; managed 8-unit rental property portfolio

Awards and Honors

- Excellence in Equity Award | American Consortium for Equity in Education | 2024
- Fulbright-Hays Group Project Participant – Nigeria (2022), Barbados (2023)

- Teacher of the Year | Lincoln Heights Academy, Charlotte, NC | 2018
 - Outstanding Teacher | Hillside High School, Durham, NC | 2016
 - Omega Psi Phi Academic Achievement Award | Central State University | 1996
 - Student Government Chief Justice | Central State University | 1996
 - Dean's Honor List | Central State University | 1995
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Research Interests

- Social Justice and Special Education: Advancing empowered inclusion through critical pedagogy
 - Epigenetics and Historical Trauma: Educational implications across generations
 - Artificial Intelligence in Education: Leveraging AI for equity and adaptive curriculum
 - Curriculum Innovation: Technology and culturally responsive frameworks
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Peer-Reviewed Publication

- **Davis, E.** (In production). *Epigenetic Consciousness: Understanding Historical Trauma, Identity Formation, and the Path to Transformational Healing*. SFU Educational Review.
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Public Scholarship & Other Publications

- **Davis, E.** (2023). *Exploring Epigenetics & the Cutting Edge of AI*. American Consortium for Equity in Education.
- **Davis, E.** (2018). *A Sequence of Events: A Tale of Epigenetic Influence and Ideas of Becoming Human*. Charlotte Teachers Institute.
- **Davis, E.** (2017). *Deconstructing Yo Fresh*. Charlotte Teachers Institute.

- *(Our)Story: African Diaspora Literacy as a Healing and Restorative Antidote to Anti-Blackness* (forthcoming).
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Conference Presentations

- **McMurtry, T., & Davis, E.** (2025, April). Linguistic healing, repair, and renewal: Reclaiming Black language in education through critical duoethnography. American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Denver, CO.
 - **Davis, E.** (2024, April). *(Our)Story: African Diaspora Literacy as a Healing and Restorative Antidote to Anti-Blackness*. AERA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.
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Selected Presentations & Invited Talks

- **Teacher Talk: The Art & Architecture of Leadership**
Presenter, Teacher Leadership Forum, Charlotte-Mecklenburg Schools, 2019
[Watch: Teacher Talk – Eli Davis](#)
 - **Guest Lecturer, University of California Riverside**
Invited Speaker, School of Education, 2020
Spoke on teaching, learning, and STEM in Black communities for EDUC 010: Principles of Learning and EDUC 245G: Educational Inequity and Opportunities. Coordinated with Dr. Amos Lee, Dr. Miguel Zavala, and Dean Joi Spencer.
 - CarolinaCAP (June 2024): Empowering Educators: Hands-On AI Prompt Engineering for Equitable Learning
 - SC Alliance of Black School Educators (Jan 2024): Empowering Educators: Hands-On AI Prompt Engineering for Equitable Learning
 - Premier 100 Conference (Feb 2023): Why Are All the Black Men Choosing Not to Teach?, Columbia, SC
 - National Council for Black Studies (March 2019): Epigenetics and Transgenerational Trauma, New Orleans, LA
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Service & Professional Involvement

- External Reviewer, Journal for Language and Literacy Education (JoLLE) | 2019 – 2020
 - Member, Race, Equity, and Leadership in Schools, Harvard Graduate School of Education | 2019
 - Leadership Team Member, Lincoln Heights Academy | 2018 – 2019
 - Board Member, Clinton and Bernice Rose Senior Community Center, Milwaukee, WI | 2004 – 2006
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Licensures

- Principal/Educational Administration (South Carolina & Alabama)
 - Cross-Categorical Special Education (South Carolina & Alabama)
 - Expired licenses in North Carolina and Wisconsin available upon request
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Podcasts, Media & Public Scholarship

- Exploring Epigenetics & the Cutting Edge of AI with Eli Davis – American Consortium for Equity in Education
 - Host, Artificial Intelligence Real Talk (AI with Eli) – All podcast mediums
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References

- **Gloria Swindler Boutte, Ph.D.** | University of South Carolina | gsboutte@mailbox.sc.edu | (803) 777-2018
- **Susi Long, Ph.D.** | University of South Carolina | slong@mailbox.sc.edu | (803) 777-7970

- **Teaira McMurtry, Ph.D.** | University of Alabama at Birmingham | mcmurtry@uab.edu | (414) 243-1736